Welcome to the LVNA
Villager
The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

April 2010 Volume 53, Number 4 Sunnyvale, California Editor Phyllis Fowler

Monthly Meeting

Wednesday, April 14th at 7:00 pm Lakewood Park building

Guests: PG & E will be discussing Smart Meters

President's Column -Fred Fowler

LVNA Election Results

At the March general meeting of the LVNA, our annual election for LVNA officers was held. Voting was by secret ballot, with outgoing LVNA Secretary Sarah Daugherty handling the counting of votes. The following people were elected to the following offices:

Fred Fowler was re-elected **President** for the 2010-2011 association year. Fred is beginning his second term as president, as he was most recently elected in November to fill the vacant 2009-2010 president's term.

Joan Simon was elected **1st Vice President** for the 2010-2011 association year. Joan is a newcomer to the LVNA leadership and is starting her first term. We welcome her and wish her good luck with her new duties.

Skip Gottschalk was elected **2nd Vice President** for the 2010-2011 association year. Skip is beginning his first current term on the LVNA board, but he is hardly a newcomer to the LVNA. He and Annie Gottschalk have been long-time volunteers for the neighborhood association, and Skip has served on the board several times in the past. I want to thank Skip for "coming out of retirement" to serve the neighborhood once again.

Beverly Woidyla was re-elected to her third and final term as **Treasurer** for the 2010-2011 association year. Bev has kept the books diligently and has taken the lead on coordinating several LVNA events. We're glad to have her back once again.

There was no candidate nominated for the position of LVNA board **Secretary**, and that position remains open. At the last LVNA board meeting, Fred Fowler was appointed Acting Secretary. Fred will serve as Acting Secretary until another candidate is appointed by the board and confirmed by a vote of the membership.

All LVNA officers serve terms of one year, starting in March of each year and ending in March of the following year. Individuals may serve for up to three consecutive years before term limits require them to spend at least one year off of the LVNA board. ◆

pril LVNA meeting:



Smart Meters!

By Fred Fowler

Come to the Lakewood Park Building at 7:00pm on Wednesday, April 14th to hear representatives from **Pacific Gas and Electric (PG&E)** give a presentation about the **Smart Meters** that are currently being installed in Lakewood Village.

The "Smart Meter" program is a new initiative by PG&E to bring high technology tools to bear on the job of delivering electricity and gas to northern California users. PG&E is reported to be spending more that $2 billion to change out all of the old "analog" meters and replace them with digital ones that can be read remotely through a huge wireless communication network. PG&E says the benefits of this project are to reduce its information gathering costs while greatly improving accuracy at the same time. They say that another benefit is that its customers (you and I) will be able to access this same data through a PG&E website, where we can watch trends in our own utility usage, compare current consumption to consumption in prior months or years, and ultimately to understand better how we are using electricity and gas. If we consumers are better informed about the energy we are using, we can make better decisions about the energy we should use and why we should use it in that way.

The benefits of this technology sound good, but this project has stirred up controversy in other parts of California. There have been newspaper reports from places like Bakersfield where residents have reported skyrocketing energy bills after the Smart Meters were installed. There have been questions about the accuracy of the meters, the utility rate structure that they make possible, and whether

This is actually a good deal for California rate payers.
(continued on page 2)

of these questions, including the

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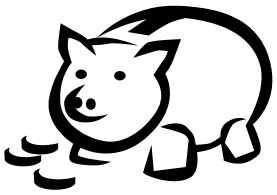
***Smart Meters** cont.*

PG&E has answers for all of these questions, including the startlingly high bills for some Bakersfield residents. Come listen to them, and ask some questions of your own! It should be a very interesting meeting. I'll see you there! ◆

Calling All Volunteers Who Like Bookkeeping: LVNA Audit Committee is Forming

By Fred Fowler

Greetings neighbors! The LVNA is in a rebuilding phase this year, with a new President (me), a new board and a "back to basics" approach that (with luck) will build the LVNA back into the effective advocate for the neighborhood that it needs to be.



Part of the "back to basics" task is to go back and review our association Bylaws to make sure we are covering all the bases that the document requires. For those of you who may be unfamiliar with bylaws, they are the equivalent of the "constitution" for organizations like the LVNA. They lay down strict requirements that the organization must follow in order to act in a lawful manner. If the LVNA organization does not comply with its bylaws, then LVNA members can sue the organization for failing to act in the members' best interests. If you would like to read the LVNA bylaws, they are available on the LVNA website http://www.lvna.net.

The bylaws have a number of requirements in them regarding the way the LVNA's money is handled. Every six months the treasurer must prepare a written report of the revenues and

***Audit Committee** cont.*

expenditures affecting the association treasury. In addition, the president must recruit and convene an "audit committee" to audit the association's books periodically to make sure the Treasurer is doing a good job.

The bylaws state that the Audit committee must consist of at least three members, and that they must be appointed by the President (me) and confirmed by a vote of the membership.

So, I would like to ask **YOU** if you would like to be a member of the audit committee? Here is what the audit committee would have to do:

- Spend one weekend afternoon with the treasurer every 6 months.
- Use that afternoon to review the LVNA's bank statements to make sure the checkbook is in balance.
- Make sure that the deposits are accounted for properly and that the source of the deposits are properly documented.
- Make sure that the checks and/or other withdrawals made represent authorized expenditures approved by the LVNA board, as recorded in the LVNA board minutes.
- Compose and sign a letter to the association reporting the results of the audit.

(continued on page 3)

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***Audit Committee** cont..*

If you are more of a poet than an accountant, this isn't the job for you. If on the other hand you like numbers and aren't afraid of the terms "debit" and "credit", this is an easy way to render an important service to your neighbors! Six months worth of deposits and withdrawals is barely a single page of entries in the treasurer's report, and it won't take long to review them. As I said, it is about an afternoon's worth of work, and I'll be happy to throw in refreshments for the session!

By the way, you need not be an "adult" to volunteer! This might be a great job for a high school student looking for something to do that will look good on a college application.

So what are you waiting for? Are you willing to give an afternoon twice per year to help the LVNA handle its finances in compliance with its bylaws? There are probably 3,500 of you reading this article now. I just need three of you to pick up the phone or send me an e-mail.

Please contact me if you are interested. My cell phone number is (408) 505-2813, and my e-mail address is fred@fmfa.com .

Thanks in advance for volunteering to help! ◆

GENERAL SCHEDULE FOR 2010

The board is looking for volunteers for the following events:

Dumpster Day is Scheduled for July 17th.

We need a *"Dumpster King" or "Dumpster Queen"* to organize the volunteer effort required to watch the dumpsters, handle the garage sale, etc.

The LVNA Picnic is Scheduled for September 25th.

This year we will attempt to get most of the food and supplies donated by local businesses and other "friends of the LVNA", instead of buying them as was done last year. We are looking for a *"Master Chef"* for the picnic to handle preparations and volunteer scheduling. We are reserving the Lakewood Park picnic area.

The next LVNA Parade is Tentatively Scheduled for December 11th.

We are looking for a *"Grand Marshall"* who will arrange to contact possible entrants as far ahead of time as possible..The scheduled date will depend on the availability of the Fremont Band. The parade will be held on the day the Fremont Band is available, and all other entrants will have to conform to their schedule.

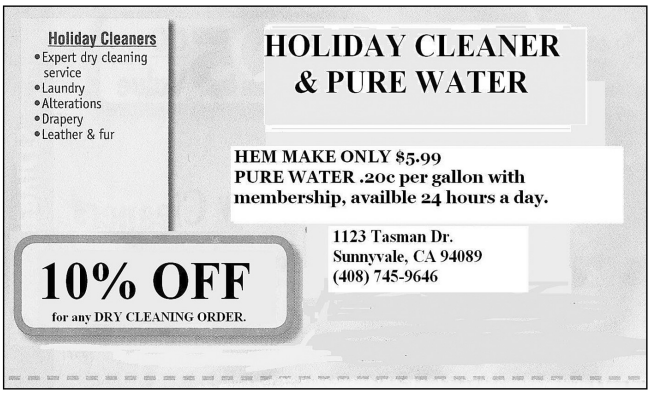
One goal is to get several other bands (such as Homestead or Wilcox) to take part. Another goal is to recruit Sunnyvale resident celebrities (such as Brian Boitano or Terry Hatcher) to take part as ceremonial parade officials.

If any of these positions tempt you, please call Fred Fowler at (408) 505-2813 or e-mail him at fred@fmfa.com . ◆

ꕥ Be Yourself. Conformity is one of the most fundamental dishonesties of all. When we reject our specialness, water down our individuality and uniqueness, we begin to lose our freedom. The conformist is in no way a free man. He has to follow the herd.

From: *Man, Morals, and Maturity*

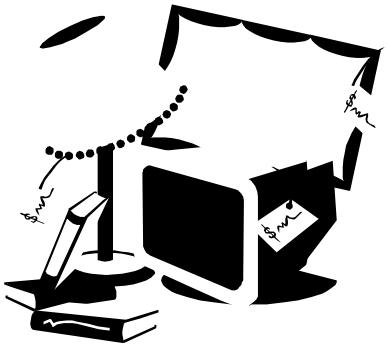
by Norman Vincent Peale ꕥ



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Fairwood School is having Rummage Sale! May 15th From 8am to 2pm

One person's junk can be someone else's treasure. Who knows what treasures you might uncover! You just might find the very item you have been searching for years!

Come one, come all to a spectacular rummage sale at Fairwood School. Support our Fairwood kids and have fun doing it! Come early and buy, buy, buy!!! ◆

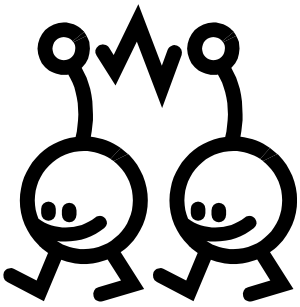
"To the praise of the glory of His grace . . ."

Providence Bible Church of Sunnyvale
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Sunday Services
9:30 a.m. Sunday School for all ages
11:00 a.m. Worship Service

Wednesday
7:00 p.m. Corporate Prayer Meeting

The Search For Life On Other Planets



Courtesy of City of Sunnyvale

Is life a miracle, or merely a cosmic infection? Today, scientists are on the verge of finding out—and learning whether what happened on this planet has happened on millions of others.

To catch us up on some of the recent developments in astrobiology, the SETI Institute's Dr. Seth Shostak will give a talk at the Sunnyvale Public Library at 7p,m, Thursday, April 29th. Dr. Shostak, who is also the author of the recent book "*Confessions of an Alien Hunter: A Scientist's Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence*", will discuss the hunt for cosmic company. The Library is located at 655 W. Olive Ave., across from city Hall. ◆

Department of Public Safety Open House

May 8th from 11:00 - 3:00



Come and see the department's new **Bearcat**, an armored rescue vehicle purchased with a federal department of Homeland security grant. There will be a **K-9** demonstration at 11:45, and an auto extraction rescue demo at 2pm. The Stanford Life Flight medical evacuation helicopter will fly in during the open house. Sunnyvale DPS is located at 700 All America Way, across the street from the Library. ◆

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Tennis Court Troublemakers?

by Fred Fowler

Last Fall the LVNA got some reports of people taking unfair advantage of the neighborhood tennis courts. The posted rules state that players should only use the courts for an hour before giving other people a chance to play. The reports the LVNA received last Fall were about groups playing all morning without giving anyone else a chance.

Now that the weather is nice again we may see a new outbreak of this kind of behavior. The Sunnyvale Parks and Recreation department would like to know if anyone gets affected by players like these who break the rules. If it happens to you, please note down the date, time of day, tennis court location, and any other relevant information and forward it to me. I'll make sure it gets to the City of Sunnyvale, and I'll follow up to find out what gets done about the reports. Please send me details via e-mail. My e-mail address is fred@fmfa.com. Please put the words "Lakewood Tennis Courts" in the subject line.

Thanks! ◆



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Important Phone Numbers

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Public Safety - Non-emergency	**730-7100**
Parks and Maintenance	730-7506
Speeding Cars, parking complaints, traffic signal repair, dead animals	Dispatch 730-7180
Complaints, about noise or commercial vehicles on residential streets	Desk Officer 730-7110
Complaints about illegal storage, decrepit fences, buildings, weed problems, illegal home businesses, or rental housing	Neighborhood Preservation 730-7610
Animal Control	730-7178
City Streets, sidewalks, trees, streetlights,	Public Works 730-7505
Nuisance Vehicle Hotline	730-7706
Drug Hotline	245-3784
Graffiti Hotline	730-7680
Shopping Cart Pickup	725-1010

Upcoming Events

What	Where	When
Street Sweeping	Your street - move your cars!	4/20 Fairwood 4/27 Lakewood 5/4 Fairwood 5/11 Lakewood
Compost Workshop	Sunnyvale Community Center Orchard Heritage Building	5/8 @ 10 am.-12pm
Household Hazardous Waste Drop-off	Carl Road, near SMaRT Station	4/17 & 5/15 8 am - 1 pm
LVNA *Villager* Editorial Deadline	Contact editor@lvna.net	4/30

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